

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform PM for multi-tenant AI infrastructure.*

Positioning, I've shipped B2B2B platforms with partner-facing APIs, multi-tenant billing, and tenant isolation, the exact surface OpenRouter Connect is building.

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§ WHY OPENROUTER

OpenRouter sits in an interesting position: the model routing layer is becoming the place where policy, cost controls, and observability actually live, not the individual model APIs. Connect takes that further by letting partners embed the full catalog inside their own products, which is a harder PM problem than it looks, you're essentially selling a platform to people who are also building platforms. The posting calls out tenant isolation, delegated administration, and per-end-user controls as the hard problems, and those are the exact questions I've worked through at EMIL Group (B2B SaaS for insurers with per-broker policy controls) and Qcrypt (enterprise security software with per-customer installation constraints). *That combination of developer experience, multi-tenant policy, and usage-based commercial mechanics is where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and refactors
- **GitHub Copilot**, daily coding assist
- **Cursor**, IDE-level code review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, spec drafting and edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD via Jenkins and GitLab, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Azure DevOps, Git, Redis, OpenShift. On the AI side: LLM agents, agentic workflow loops, prompt engineering, evaluation pipelines, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act compliance framing.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace built solo, zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that keeps both sides protected before commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents handle funnel qualification and matching.
 - Funnel and conversion tracking in SQL; one person runs the full day-to-day.
 - Shows I can own the full stack, API design, multi-party trust mechanics, and agentic automation, which maps directly to Connect's partner onboarding and end-user provisioning problems.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT OPENROUTER

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the two or three active partner integration calls, read every existing Connect spec and support thread, and map where partners stall, provisioning API gaps, auth questions, or metering ambiguity, so I have a prioritised gap list before writing a single line of roadmap.

WEEK 2

Slice the roadmap.

Pick the one integration blocker that affects the most partners and write a tight spec with clear acceptance criteria, API contract, and a definition of done that includes the observability dimension.

Ship, then generalise.

Land the first slice, run a short retro with the partner, and push any primitives exposed as missing back into core so the fix benefits every OpenRouter customer, not just the one partner who surfaced it.

I COVER LETTER

Dear OpenRouter team,

I've spent 13 years as a Product Manager and Product Owner shipping platform products that other companies' engineers build on. The problems Connect is solving, tenant isolation, delegated administration, per-end-user policy, usage metering across a partner's customer base, are not new to me. At EMIL Group I owned a B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, and brokers where each client needed its own policy controls and billing view. At Qcrypt I built an enterprise security product with per-customer installation and licensing constraints. Both required the same thinking Connect does: you're not just building features, you're building abstractions that hold up when a dozen partners each have different requirements for their own customers.

The zero-to-one dimension of this role is also familiar. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production in an 18-person organisation that had lost its senior engineers and its clients' trust. At construct8, my current venture, I built a two-sided B2B marketplace alone: partner onboarding, anonymity-until-payment mechanics, LLM agents across the funnel, and SQL-based conversion tracking. Getting a product from design partners to general availability while keeping the abstractions clean rather than piling up one-off integrations is the part of the job I find most interesting.

On the technical side: I read API specs, call SDKs myself, and have strong opinions about auth models and tenant isolation. I've shipped GitOps rollout pipelines with ArgoCD, owned ETL and data platform products with Dagster and dbt, and built agentic workflow loops with n8n and LLM tooling. I use OpenRouter in my own work, so I come with a real user's sense of where the friction sits in the current developer experience.

The commercial model question, building a win-win-win for partners, their end customers, and OpenRouter, is exactly the kind of problem I want to be close to. At Kvitt Payment Solutions, the mobile P2P payments startup I co-founded and took to acquisition by Sparkasse, I worked through revenue share and billing mechanics on both sides of a partnership. I know what finance teams on each side need from metering and invoicing, and I know what it takes to make usage-based pricing feel fair rather than opaque.

I'm based in Berlin, work fully remote, and am available on four weeks' notice. I'd be glad to talk through any of this in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership across platform, infrastructure, and regulated B2B SaaS products. I've shipped partner-facing API products, multi-tenant policy controls, and usage-based billing mechanics in defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, and security. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform (AI) for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams and making the platform hotfix-capable.

- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis: instrumented two competing workflows, cut the UI-led path that recorded zero usage, and increased pipeline runs by 200%.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt for quarterly ETL imports, saving close to 75% of the time per data update and removing hand-holding from routine runs.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers, giving the team autonomous control of its own environments, alongside a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER (AI), EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL &
CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework) setup.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

Government. Secure data platform; identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware; still in production. Owned backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-PRESENT

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace matching firms with workers.

- Built zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016-12/2021

IT security. Integrated hardware and software for quantum-secure encryption.

- Enterprise buyers required fast deployment, so I shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018-08/2021

Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013-11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

- Built from zero to acquisition, working through revenue share, billing, and partnership mechanics on both sides.

§ SKILLS

AI Products and Tooling: LLM (large language model) agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Platform and API Product Management: multi-tenant architecture, tenant isolation, delegated administration, partner onboarding, provisioning APIs, usage metering, API design, developer experience, B2B SaaS.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes (K8s), Docker, GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt (data build tool), SQL, OpenShift.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning as CFO, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)

